counted to be thirty-four in number. He has written couplets in praise of those places:[*]

> Kābul in Spring is an Eden of verdure and blossom;
> Matchless in Kābul the Spring of Gul-i-bahār and Bārān.
> He also composed the below limerick on the excursion:
> My heart, like the bud of the red, red rose,
> Lies fold within fold aflame;
> Would the breath of even a myriad Springs
> Blow my heart's bud to a rose?

Babur found a few places over there very similar like those for the spring excursions, hawking or bird-shooting in Kābul and Ghaznī.

That year, the begs of Badakhshān—Muhammad the armourer, Mubārak Shāh, Zubair Jahāngīr etc.—were furious with Nāṣir Mīrzā and his followers. They brought out an army of soldiers on horses and those on feet. They were arrayed on the plains by the edge of Kūkcha-water and soon they began to move towards Yaftal and Rāgh, near Khamchān, taking the route of lower hills. Nāṣir Mīrzā came to fight back—he was inexperienced, and so were the begs by his side. The lack of experience was evident as they arrived to battle at lower hills, a battlefield which was contoured in various ways.

The Badakhshīs had several men on foot who were ready to counter the Mīrzā's horse and his allies multiple times over. The Mīrzā and his men couldn't face them and were beaten and plundered . . . almost stripped bare.

The defeated ones, about eighty men, took the road through Ishkīmīsh and Nārīn to Kīlā-gāhī. They got out on the Āb-dara road, making a crossing at Shibr-tū, and made their way to the Kābul. They appeared worn-out, naked and famished.

This conflict delighted Babur for a few obvious personal reasons:

> That was a marvelous sign of the Divine might! Two or three years earlier the Mīrzā had left the Kābul country like a foe, driving tribes and hordes like sheep before him, reached Badakhshān and made fast its forts and valley-strongholds. With what fancy in his mind had he marched out? Now he was back, hanging the head of shame for those earlier misdeeds, humbled and distraught about that breach with me!

Nāṣir Mīrzā was sceptical about how he would be received for he was aware of his misdeeds. But to his surprise, Babur didn't show him any displeasure. Instead, with a smile, he enquired about his well-being.